

## **CATEGORY 4 – SAP GRC ACCESS CONTROL**

### **Chapter 6 – MSMP & BRF+ (Workflow Engine Deep Dive)**

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#### **Q68. What is MSMP?**

##### **Interviewer's Objective**

The interviewer wants to determine whether you understand the workflow architecture behind SAP GRC rather than simply approving requests.

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##### **Executive Answer**

MSMP (Multi-Step Multi-Process Workflow) is the workflow engine used by SAP GRC Access Control to automate approval processes.

It determines:

- Who approves the request
- In what order approvals occur
- Parallel or sequential approvals
- Escalation rules
- Notifications
- Workflow completion

MSMP separates workflow logic from business logic, making workflows configurable rather than hardcoded.

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##### **Business Benefits**

MSMP provides:

- Standardized approvals
- Workflow automation
- Audit trail
- Flexible routing
- Escalation management
- Compliance

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**Q69. Explain the MSMP Architecture.**

**Executive Answer**

**The MSMP workflow consists of several logical components.**

**Access Request**



**Process ID**



**Workflow Path**



**Stages**



**Agents**



**Notifications**



**Provisioning**

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## **Components**

### **Component Purpose**

|                |                                   |
|----------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>Process</b> | <b>Defines workflow type</b>      |
| <b>Path</b>    | <b>Determines routing</b>         |
| <b>Stage</b>   | <b>Individual approval step</b>   |
| <b>Agent</b>   | <b>Approver</b>                   |
| <b>Action</b>  | <b>Approve / Reject / Forward</b> |

**Notification Email alerts**

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## **Q70. What is a Process ID?**

### **Executive Answer**

**A Process ID uniquely identifies a workflow.**

### **Examples:**

- **New User Request**
- **Role Assignment**
- **Firefighter Assignment**
- **Role Modification**
- **User Deletion**

### **Each Process ID has its own:**

- **Workflow**
- **Approval stages**
- **BRF+ rules**
- **Notifications**

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### **Example**

#### **Process ID**

**SAP\_GRAC\_ACCESS\_REQUEST**

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#### **Manager Approval**

↓

#### **Role Owner**

↓

#### **Security**

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## **Provision**

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### **Q71. What is a Stage?**

#### **Executive Answer**

**A Stage is one approval step within an MSMP workflow.**

#### **Examples**

##### **Stage 1**

##### **Manager Approval**

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##### **Stage 2**

##### **Role Owner**

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##### **Stage 3**

##### **Security Review**

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##### **Stage 4**

##### **Provisioning**

**Each stage must complete before the workflow moves to the next stage unless parallel approval is configured.**

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### **Q72. What is a Path?**

#### **Executive Answer**

**A Path defines the sequence of stages.**

#### **Example**

##### **Path A**

##### **Manager**

↓

**Security**

↓

**Provision**

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**Path B**

**Manager**

↓

**Risk Owner**

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**Compliance**

↓

**Provision**

**BRF+ determines which path should be selected.**

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**Q73. What is an Agent?**

**Executive Answer**

**An Agent is the person or group responsible for approving a workflow stage.**

**Examples:**

- **Manager**
- **Role Owner**
- **Security Administrator**
- **Compliance Officer**
- **Firefighter Owner**

**Agents can be determined:**

- **Statically**
  - **Dynamically using BRF+**
  - **From HR organizational data**
  - **Through organizational rules**
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**Q74. Explain BRF+.**

**This is one of the most frequently asked technical questions.**

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**Executive Answer**

**BRF+ (Business Rule Framework Plus) is SAP's rule engine used to make workflow decisions.**

**MSMP controls how the workflow runs.**

**BRF+ decides where it goes.**

**BRF+ determines:**

- **Approvers**
  - **Paths**
  - **Notifications**
  - **Escalations**
  - **Conditional routing**
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**Example**

**IF Company Code = 1000**

**↓**

**Finance Manager**

**ELSE**

**Finance Director**

**No ABAP coding is required.**

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#### **Q75. Difference Between MSMP and BRF+**

| <b>MSMP</b>              | <b>BRF+</b>               |
|--------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>Workflow engine</b>   | <b>Rule engine</b>        |
| <b>Controls workflow</b> | <b>Controls decisions</b> |
| <b>Stages</b>            | <b>Routing logic</b>      |
| <b>Approval sequence</b> | <b>Business rules</b>     |
| <b>Notifications</b>     | <b>Conditions</b>         |

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#### **Interview Tip**

**A simple way to explain it is:**

**MSMP is the road. BRF+ is the GPS deciding which road to take.**

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#### **Q76. Explain Parallel vs Sequential Approval.**

##### **Sequential Approval**

**Approvers act one after another.**

**Manager**

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**Role Owner**

↓

**Security**

↓

**Provision**

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## **Parallel Approval**

**Multiple approvers receive the request simultaneously.**

**Manager**

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**Role Owner**

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↓

**Provision**

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## **When to Use**

### **Sequential:**

- **High-risk requests**
- **Financial access**
- **Production access**

### **Parallel:**

- **Low-risk requests**
  - **Faster turnaround**
  - **Independent approvals**
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## **Q77. How does MSMP determine Approvers?**

### **Executive Answer**

**Approvers can be determined using:**

- **Manager hierarchy**
- **Role Owner**
- **HR Organizational Structure**
- **BRF+ Decision Tables**



- Custom Rules
- Compliance Owners

Dynamic determination improves scalability and reduces manual maintenance.

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**Q78. Explain Escalation in MSMP.**

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**Executive Answer**

Escalation ensures workflows continue if an approver does not respond.

**Example**

**Manager**

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**No response for 48 hours**

↓

**Reminder**

↓

**Escalation to Director**

↓

**Approval**

Escalations prevent workflow bottlenecks.

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**Q79. Explain Notifications.**

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Notifications inform users about workflow events.

**Examples:**

- New Request
- Approval Required
- Request Approved
- Request Rejected

- **Firefighter Review**
- **Provisioning Completed**

**Notifications improve visibility and reduce delays.**

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**Q80. How do you troubleshoot a stuck MSMP Workflow?**

**This is one of the most common production support questions.**

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**Executive Answer**

**I follow a structured troubleshooting methodology.**

**Step 1**

**Check workflow status.**

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**Step 2**

**Identify current stage.**

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**Step 3**

**Verify BRF+ rule execution.**

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**Step 4**

**Confirm agent determination.**

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**Step 5**

**Review escalation rules.**

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**Step 6**

**Check notification delivery.**

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**Step 7**

**Validate connector and provisioning status.**

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**Step 8**

**Review application logs.**

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**Step 9**

**Coordinate with Basis if RFC or system issues exist.**

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**Step 10**

**Test the corrected workflow in QA before implementing changes in Production.**

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**Q81. Common MSMP Issues**

| <b>Issue</b>               | <b>Possible Cause</b>           |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>Request stuck</b>       | <b>Missing approver</b>         |
| <b>Wrong approver</b>      | <b>BRF+ rule error</b>          |
| <b>Duplicate approvals</b> | <b>Incorrect path design</b>    |
| <b>No notification</b>     | <b>Mail configuration issue</b> |
| <b>Provisioning failed</b> | <b>Connector/RFC problem</b>    |
| <b>Workflow loops</b>      | <b>Incorrect routing logic</b>  |

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**Q82. Real Interview Scenario**

**Interviewer**

***"A Production Access Request is waiting for approval. The manager has left the company. What would you do?"***

**Executive Answer**

**I would first confirm where the request is waiting within the MSMP workflow and verify why the approval has not progressed. I would then review how the approver is determined—through HR hierarchy, Role Owner assignment, or BRF+ rules.**

If the manager has left the organization, I would work with HR or the business to identify the officially designated replacement or delegate rather than manually bypassing the workflow. If delegation or substitution is already configured, I would verify that it is functioning correctly. After resolving the immediate request, I would update the organizational data or BRF+ rules to ensure future requests are routed to the correct approver.

This preserves governance while avoiding recurring workflow failures.

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### **Q83. Real Manufacturing Scenario**

**Interviewer**

*"During an S/4HANA go-live weekend, hundreds of access requests are delayed because the approval workflow is too long. Business leaders ask you to remove several approval steps temporarily. What would you recommend?"*

**Executive Answer**

I would avoid removing governance controls without assessing the associated risk.

My approach would be:

1. Categorize requests by risk level.
2. Fast-track low-risk requests through an approved simplified workflow.
3. Retain full approvals for high-risk or production-critical access.
4. Enable temporary parallel approvals where appropriate to reduce turnaround time.
5. Ensure ARA continues to run before provisioning.
6. Monitor workflow volumes throughout the go-live period and restore the standard workflow once hypercare is complete.

This approach maintains compliance while supporting business continuity during a critical deployment.

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### **Senior Consultant Tips**

When discussing MSMP and BRF+:

- Emphasize workflow governance, not just configuration.
- Explain how BRF+ enables dynamic routing without custom ABAP.

- Highlight business continuity through escalation and delegation.
  - Demonstrate a structured troubleshooting methodology for workflow issues.
  - Connect your answers to S/4HANA transformation and manufacturing go-live scenarios, where workflow efficiency is critical.
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## End of Chapter 6

At this point, we've covered the complete SAP GRC Access Control suite:

-  Access Risk Analysis (ARA)
-  Access Request Management (ARM)
-  Emergency Access Management (EAM)
-  Business Role Management (BRM)
-  MSMP & BRF+

## Next Chapter – SAP GRC Rule Set Management & Mitigation Controls

This chapter will cover:

- Rule Set Architecture
- Function & Action Design
- Permission Design
- Custom Rule Creation
- Mitigation Controls
- Risk Acceptance
- Organizational Rule Sets
- Cross-System SoD
- False Positive Reduction
- Real Audit Scenarios
- Advanced troubleshooting

This is one of the most advanced SAP GRC topics and is frequently discussed in architect-level interviews because it demonstrates both technical expertise and governance maturity.